

RI.UVT.RO Redesign

Role 2 Implementation Plan

UX Researcher + Frontend Contributor

Headless WordPress + React Environment

1. Role Overview

The UX Researcher + Frontend Contributor identifies usability issues and transforms them into practical interface improvements. This role bridges user needs and real implementation, ensuring the React frontend and WordPress content structure support clear navigation, discoverability, and decision-making.

2. Phase 1: Audit and User Analysis

Actual Work

- Analyse the current ri.uvt.ro platform page by page.
- Identify usability issues:
 - Confusing navigation
 - Redundant or unclear pages
 - Weak call-to-actions
 - Overloaded document-based journeys
- Map key user groups:
 - Incoming students
 - Outgoing students
 - Partner institutions
 - Academic staff
 - International applicants
- Identify friction points in current journeys.
- Review how content structure affects user experience.

Deliverable

- Documented UX audit with prioritised problem list and user-needs summary.

3. Phase 2: User Flows and Navigation Design

Actual Work

- Define audience journeys:
 - Incoming student path
 - Outgoing student path
 - Partner institution path
 - Staff services path
- Design navigation logic:
 - Main menu structure
 - Submenu grouping
 - Quick-access links
 - Footer wayfinding
- Propose UX improvements:
 - Clear entry points
 - Reduced navigation depth
 - Better page grouping
 - Guided process pages

Deliverable

- Defined sitemap contribution, navigation model, and user flow diagrams.

4. Phase 3: Frontend Navigation Implementation

Actual Work

- Collaborate on implementing navigation in the React frontend:
 - Main navigation
 - Mobile navigation
 - Secondary menus
 - Breadcrumb systems
- Build UX helpers:
 - Quick-access sections
 - Support entry points

- CTA placements
- Route guidance elements
- Ensure navigation consistency across all routes.

Deliverable

- Functional and user-tested navigation system integrated into the React frontend.

5. Phase 4: Search and Interaction Features

Actual Work

- Assist with or define:
 - Search experience
 - Filter systems for programmes, documents, opportunities, or news
- Improve interaction patterns:
 - Expandable sections
 - Accordions
 - Tabs where justified
 - Guided content blocks
- Ensure features improve usability instead of adding complexity.

Deliverable

- Interaction systems that improve discoverability and clarity.

6. Phase 5: API-fed Page Usability Validation

Actual Work

- Review completed React pages populated from WordPress content.
- Validate:
 - Clarity of navigation
 - Ease of reaching important information
 - Logical content grouping
 - Mobile usability
 - Readability of dynamic content
- Identify friction points and recommend fixes.

Deliverable

- UX validation report with actionable refinements.

7. Phase 6: Collaboration and Iteration

Actual Work

- Work closely with:
 - Role 1 — Frontend Lead (implementation consistency)
 - Role 3 — IA / WordPress structure alignment
 - Role 5 — React pages and components
 - Role 7 — Content clarity and messaging
- Iterate on navigation and interaction based on feedback.
- Support final launch-readiness review.

Deliverable

- Refined and validated UX across the full platform.

8. Final Output Responsibilities

- UX audit of the existing website
- Defined user journeys and navigation logic
- Improved React navigation patterns
- Search / filter / interaction recommendations
- API-fed page usability validation
- Final UX refinement before launch

This role ensures every interface decision serves real users, transforming complexity into clarity through both analysis and implementation.